

LO1 Orientation

Fontys ICT, StartSemester

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Learning outcome	LO1 Orientation
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I used AI (Claude) to help with the structure and English in this document. All the background, opinions, and choices are my own.

1. My starting point

I am 25. My official school education is ESO. I do not have a degree from before Fontys.

Before Fontys, I explored technology in several ways. I completed a one-year E-Commerce Specialist bootcamp, which I enjoyed and which sparked my interest in digital business, though I have forgotten many details since then. Later, I did a Data Science bootcamp in Madrid and earned a certificate. There, I worked with basic Python, data cleaning, data analysis, and some Machine Learning. It was my first real experience with programming. I also realized that my math and statistics skills were not strong enough to fully understand Machine Learning.

I continued learning on my own. I followed the AI and Data Scientist roadmap on roadmap.sh, checked out Stanford's introductory statistics, and tried Mathematics for Machine Learning, but I got stuck on vectors and derivatives. I also explored cybersecurity on TryHackMe, focusing more on information than programming. I started a Full Stack course on Udemy but only completed half, so I know a bit of HTML. I also began using Git, GitHub, VS Code, and Obsidian for my notes.

I am starting at Fontys with a broad but uneven background. I have tried many areas, but I am not advanced in most of them. Some topics I know at a basic level, and others are completely new to me. My work experience is in hospitality and catering, not ICT. From those jobs, I learned how to work with people and handle time pressure.

I learn best by doing things myself. I like to see how something works, try it out, run into problems, figure out why, and then use the solution in a project. My goal at Fontys is to turn what I learned on my own into a solid and structured foundation.

2. Workshops I followed

One short line per workshop: what I took from it, and if it was new for me.

Date	Workshop	What I took from it
1 Sep	Portfolio	To be honest, it was not clear to me how the portfolio and the learning outcomes work. I was quite confused, and I think this is one of the reasons I got behind in my project.

Date	Workshop	What I took from it
2 Sep	Orientation	Same as the Portfolio workshop. I understood the idea, but not how it works in practice.
3 Sep	IT Process: Analysis & Advice	All new for me. I used MoSCoW for the first time in my Analysis for The Witness.
4 Sep	How to Use AI (Part 1)	AI is a tool, and it is my responsibility how I use it. I use it to correct me, to explain things in a different way, and as a second opinion on professional topics.
7 Sep	IT Process: Design	Also new for me. I used it for the flowchart and the Design document of The Witness.
7 Sep	Feedback	Useful. Feedback from my coaches changed my documents and my game.
14 Sep	Cultural Awareness (Part 1)	I noticed a big difference with Spain. In Spain teachers are always on top of you. Here you get a lot of freedom.
14 Sep	IT Process: Realisation & Validation	Quite new for me. I had never heard of validation as a phase before.
14 Sep	Guest lecture: Accessibility in ICT	I really liked this one. Part of it was not new for me: in the Udemy Full Stack course they explained why headers and similar things are important for accessibility.

3. The ICT fields I explored

Date	Field	What I think
7 and 14 Sep	Game Development	Completely new for me. I had never made a game before The Witness.
8 and 15 Sep	AI Basics	A talk about how AI works and how to use it as a tool. Not much was new, because in my bootcamp we went deeper: deep learning, machine learning and neural networks.
8 and 15 Sep	Software Design & Engineering	It attracts me, but it is a very big field and it is still not fully clear to me what it includes.
10 Sep	Smart Industry	It did not really catch my attention.
11 Sep	Interactive Media	It attracts me a lot, because it is close to creative development. But I am a bit worried about money, and about AI, because I think AI can do a lot of this work easily.
11 Sep	Intelligent Technologies	My favourite workshop. I thought it was really cool.

Date	Field	What I think
16 Sep	Cyber Security	Interesting to see how it works. It is a field I am really interested in, and every ICT person needs the basics anyway.
16 Sep	Process Data in Organisations	It reminded me of my Data Science bootcamp.

Game Development

Before Fontys, I had no experience with game development. The Witness is the first game I am making, and I am learning Godot as I go. It is a 2D top-down stealth game with a noir style inspired by Sin City. In the game, a witness sees a murder by gangsters and must escape without being seen.

At first, I wanted to use realistic top-down sprites for the characters, but that turned out to be too difficult and I got stuck. So I changed my approach. I used Mixamo mannequin animations in Blender, placed a camera above them, and took frames from the animations. This created the faceless mannequin style the game has now. My coach advised me to document this problem and the change instead of hiding it. This was an important lesson for me: when a plan does not work, I can try a different way instead of giving up.

Intelligent Technologies

This was my favorite workshop. I enjoyed it a lot. However, there are still some things about working in this field that I am unsure about. I want to learn more before making a decision.

Cybersecurity

I have been interested in cybersecurity since I tried it on TryHackMe. I enjoy learning how systems work and how they are protected. The challenge is that there is a lot of information to take in. Still, it is one of the fields I want to explore further.

Creative development and Interactive Media

I enjoy the mix of programming and creativity, such as making interactive websites or 3D content on the web with Three.js. However, I have some doubts. I am not sure if this field pays well, and I think AI can already do much of this work. For now, it is more of an interest than a career direction.

4. My conclusion for now

I have tried a lot of things, and I still do not know exactly what I want to do. I think that is honest for where I am.

Before Fontys, my strongest experience was in data science from my bootcamp and in cybersecurity, mainly on the information side.

Game development is completely new to me. I am learning it every day by working on The Witness.

After these weeks, the two fields I like most are Intelligent Technologies, which was my favorite workshop, and Cybersecurity, which I already enjoyed before coming to Fontys.

I need to work on programming fundamentals, math and statistics, confidence with Git, and project planning. I also want to finish learning paths instead of moving on to new topics too quickly.

My next step: my choice is still open. Before I choose, I want to find out more about Intelligent Technologies and Cybersecurity, and see which one fits me better. For Intelligent Technologies I will ask the teacher what the work in this field really looks like.

5. Evidence connected to this document

Evidence	Date	What it shows
Analysis 0.2 - The Witness	23 Sep 2026	Problem, client, MoSCoW with user stories, sources.
Advice - engine and AI choice	24 Sep 2026	Why I chose Godot, and why Q-learning is a Could Have.
Design	24 Sep 2026	Scene tree, level layout and the Hunter design.
Game code on GitHub	15 to 25 Sep 2026	Player movement, animations, first test level.
Devlog	Weeks 2 to 4	My research about Q-learning and Godot, and what I learned each day.
Feedback from Frank and Faruk	14 and 15 Sep 2026	How I changed my documents and my game after feedback.